

How to respond when the objection is... the PRICE!

Note: The price issue should be addressed **reactively** rather than proactively with the physician.

It is important to know the reasons why price may or may not be an obstacle. The context will be crucial to define which way to go.

We can never compare the price of products that are not comparable (e.g., with a different patient profile, with a different prescription regimen, with a different indication, etc.).

PRICE $\neq$ VALUE



Different ways to express the objection

- “I would gladly recommend the *Bial* product, if it wasn't so expensive.”
- “I don't switch to the *Bial* product because it's expensive.”
- “I don't prescribe the *Bial* product because it's very expensive.”
- “I usually recommend another option, which is cheaper.”
- “It's better to do something (another option / generic option / etc.) than to do nothing.”
- “The generic option is the same and it's cheaper.”
- “Patients say they don't have the financial capacity to buy this product.”

ALWAYS ask the physician

- It's expensive vs. what?
 - Find out which alternative (specific product / brand / generic option, etc.) the physician uses and crunch the numbers, to see if it's a valid objection.
 - “Expensive” is relative. What a physician may consider expensive may be an acceptable value for the patient, and vice versa.

To respond,
you need to
know:

About the *Bial* product:

- The price of the product.
- The price of treatment per day

$$= \left(\frac{\text{price of product}}{\text{no. tablets per pack}} \right) \times \text{no tablets per day}$$

- Competitive advantages (vs. the various competitors).
- The benefits of the product.
- Product positioning and patient profile for which it is indicated.

About the competition:

- The price of the product.
- The price of treatment per day

$$= \left(\frac{\text{price of product}}{\text{no. tablets per pack}} \right) \times \text{no tablets per day}$$

- Advantages and disadvantages of competitors - to know how to refute and value our product.

Ultimately,
just do the
maths:

EXAMPLE:

- Price of treatment per day:

Bial Product – €0.50

Competitor – €0.35

Difference: €0.15

Question the physician:

- Doctor, how expensive might it be in the future not to use these €0.15/day?
- Is the patient unwilling to pay €0.15/day more for a more [insert [*competitive advantage*](#)] treatment?
- After presenting you this benefits, is the price difference justifiable for you?
 - If “Yes.”: That being the case, you could ask your patients if they would be willing to obtain these benefits for the slight price difference in question.

Possible
competitive
advantages that
we can point
out:

- GREATER THERAPEUTIC ADHERENCE – depends on:
 - Pharmaceutical format - Tablets vs. Oral solution vs. Others (understand which will be the most advantageous for the population in question).
 - Pack contents (therapy facilitators) - applicator, dosing syringe, measuring spoon.
 - No. of tablets and daily doses - The smaller, the greater the therapeutic adherence and, consequently, the effectiveness.
 - Duration of treatment - Shorter treatments are, in principle, simpler to comply with and maintain.
- GREATER EFFICIENCY
- FASTER TO ACT
- BETTER TOLERABILITY (= fewer adverse effects)

Among many others...

Closing...:

The difference between the *Bial* product and the competitor is €0.15/day.

But the difference between Bial and the other laboratories is huge! Bial has a Medical Sales Representative team that regularly supports the medical profession. Bial invests 20% of its turnover in research and development, not in copies.

BIAL is the physician's partner. By letting the pharmacy choose, you lose your right to choose.

Practical example - medical visit simulation:

The sales representative visits a General Practitioner, introducing them to the Sedoxil / Melex brand. In the medical visit, the sales rep addresses the profile of an active hard-working patient, 35 years old, and with 4 children, with Reactive Anxiety. The sales rep is presenting the advantages of Sedoxil / Melex in this profile when they are stopped by the physician: "But I don't prescribe Sedoxil / Melex because it's too expensive." The sales rep has a price objection before them, so they ask "Doctor, it's expensive compared to what? Which option do you prefer in these cases?" Despite being reticent, the physician ends up answering "I usually recommend Alprazolam; It's effective and cheaper."

So let's do the maths: in the country in question, a pack of Sedoxil / Melex (30 tablets of 1 mg) costs €4.68. The no. 1 selling brand of Alprazolam (14 tablets of 1 mg) costs €1.83.

Knowing that 1 mg of mexazolam is equivalent to 0.5-1 mg of Alprazolam, let's compare the price of treatment per day of equivalent doses, considering 1 tablet of 1 mg per day for both options, using the following formula: $\frac{\text{price of product}}{\text{no. of tablets in a package}} \times \text{no. of tablets per day}$.

$$\text{Sedoxil / Melex: } \frac{4,68}{30} \times 1 = \text{€0.16/day}$$

$$\text{Alprazolam: } \frac{1,83}{14} \times 1 = \text{€0.13/day}$$

$$\text{Difference: } 0.16 - 0.13 = \text{€0.03/day} (= \text{€0.90/month})$$

Knowing that the difference per day is only €0.03, the sales representative asks the doctor: "Doctor, how expensive might it be in the future not to use these €0.03/day (or €0.90/month)? Imagine the following scenario: your active and hard-working patient feels very sleepy during the day when starting treatment with Alprazolam and, as such, cannot maintain their productivity at work. Will your active patient be willing to pay €0.03 more/day, knowing that the treatment for their anxiety will not cause them sedation and, as such, they will be able to live their day-to-day life without restrictions? What is the price of well-being and better quality of life for your patient?"

NOTE: It is important for the sales representative to know the product and the competitor's product well and what arguments should be used to justify the price difference.